Gavin Sutton (AfCGI)

Software Engineering Manager | Engineering Leadership

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PROFILE

I'm a Software Engineering Manager who builds trust, psychological safety and clear accountability. I set direction, scope, priorities and delivery expectations, and coach senior engineers with their own line-management responsibilities to lead their teams, make decisions and develop their people.

My experience spans customer-facing products, platform integration and major sporting events, backed by data engineering, architecture and analytics. Earlier work across utilities, financial services and the charity sector gives me a broader understanding of customer operations and commercial priorities. I connect that perspective with engineering decisions, helping teams deliver while growing more capable, confident and self-sufficient.

CAREER HISTORY

Engineering Manager | June 2023 - Present

Flutter Entertainment

Lead engineering delivery for Free-to-Play customer products across multiple Flutter brands: free-to-enter sports games including ITV7, Super 6, Darts Checkout Challenge, Super Swipes and World Cup offerings.

- Agree priorities with Product, Delivery and Architecture; resolve dependencies across teams and protect planned delivery from unnecessary disruption. Contribute to wider engineering strategy and standards.
- Manage and coach two Senior Software Engineers with formal line-management responsibilities that I introduced, with leadership approval, to build succession for future Engineering Managers.
- Supported colleagues in completing ILM Level 3 and Level 5 leadership qualifications and technical certifications, including AWS Certified AI Practitioner. Supported engineer-to-senior promotions and progression from Senior Engineer to Tech Lead, championing an evidence-based promotion case through a management change.
- Led product delivery and evolution following the transfer in-house from a third-party provider in June 2023. Set direction and scope for ITV7 Football and the return of ITV7 Sweepstakes on a new technology stack.
- Led platform integration work and supported readiness for the 2026 World Cup, regular football seasons and major horse-racing events, including Cheltenham, the Grand National, Royal Ascot, Goodwood and Ebor.
- Championed Artificial Intelligence (AI) adoption within Reward and Free-to-Play over the past 12 months through the AI Champions initiative. Supported engineers delivering requirements and test-readiness review agents, including one adopted elsewhere through the business-wide internal AI platform.
- Supported delivery of a Claude-based AI tool for Bitbucket pull-request reviews, flagging dependencies and potential impacts with red, amber and green statuses to support better-informed human review.
- Supported AI tools for codebase-informed change analysis, runbook updates and Jira ticket creation, and comparison of proposed features to assess likely uptake and value and inform requirements. Asked by the Head of Technology to share this work across the wider business.
- Oversee CI/CD, automated testing, technical debt and release readiness. Led resilience and capacity improvements for peaks in demand. Use Grafana to understand service health; draw on awareness of Amazon Web Services (AWS), PHP and React in technical discussions and code reviews.
- Serve as Incident Commander for P1/P2 incidents and lower-priority escalations through PagerDuty. Coordinate the response, involve the right engineers and specialists, and oversee work to restore service.

Lead Software Engineer | January 2023 - June 2023

Flutter Entertainment

Led engineers in the Customer Data Hub squad, combining line management with technical and delivery responsibility. Supported progression through one-to-ones, coaching and development planning. Worked with engineers, architects and stakeholders on solution design, priorities and dependencies.

Data Engineer | July 2020 - January 2023

Flutter Entertainment

- Built and maintained data pipelines in the Data Gaming squad, improving performance and data quality. Contributed to migration to Google Cloud Platform (GCP). Technologies included BigQuery, Airflow, Kubernetes, Spark, SQL, Kafka, Hadoop, Cloudera and Scala.
- Supported services through the out-of-hours on-call rota, diagnosed failures, reviewed code, participated in deployments and mentored colleagues and new starters.

Data Warehouse Architect | June 2019 - July 2020

StepChange Debt Charity

Led data-warehouse architecture and development, including new data marts and legacy migrations. Improved reliability, availability, recovery and performance. Translated reporting requirements into technical solutions, aligned priorities and coached BI developers. Worked with Microsoft SQL Server, SSIS and SSRS.

MI Data Analyst | September 2015 - May 2019

Medical Protection Society

Delivered reporting and analysis, improving access to information through automation and self-service. Contributed to strategic transformation workshops and Target Operating Model discussions as a subject-matter expert, translating business requirements into technical implementation.

Customer, data and leadership roles | July 2003 - September 2015

British Gas / Centrica

- Progressed into MI development, technical leadership, business partnering and credit-risk leadership. Managed analysts and reporting professionals, leading delivery, prioritisation, standards and process improvement across commercial, operational and technology functions.
- Led offshore partner delivery through a Genpact tower lead and their team across Hyderabad and Bangalore under a dotted-line arrangement. Set direction and delivery expectations, integrating offshore colleagues into team meetings and progress reporting with accountability to me for delivery.
- Transferred technical and business knowledge to the offshore partner and developed collection and recovery strategies informed by credit-risk analysis.

Operational and management roles | June 1995 - July 2003

Catering industry

Progressed from customer service to Team Leader and Assistant Manager, with line-management responsibility for teams of up to 12 people.

QUALIFICATIONS AND PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Affiliateship of the City and Guilds of London Institute (AfCGI)
City & Guilds of London Institute | September 2025

ILM Level 5 Award in Leadership and Management
Leeds Beckett University | September 2025
Leadership development focused on leading through other people managers.

ILM Level 3 Leadership and Management
Leeds Beckett University | December 2023
Practical management, team motivation, relationships and leadership capability.